

Machine learning in battery management systems: a structured scoping review and classification of 103 peer-reviewed studies, 2019–2026

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Abstract—Machine learning (ML) has moved from a promising addition to battery research to a load-bearing component of modern battery management systems (BMS), yet the validation practices behind the literature’s accuracy claims have never been systematically measured. This paper presents a structured scoping review of 103 peer-reviewed journal articles (2019–2026) — assembled from a Crossref-verified pool and classified uniformly by management function, method family, chemistry, data source, and validation practice — supported by a 14-paper conference sensitivity set. The bibliometric analysis reveals a clear evolution: classical shallow learners dominated 2019–2021, deep sequence models rose sharply in 2022–2023, physics-informed and hybrid model–data approaches became one of the fastest-growing families (24 of 103 papers), and the first large-language-model-based management studies appear in 2025–2026. Health estimation and prognostics remain the largest application cluster (35 papers). Three structural weaknesses persist. Only 9 of 103 studies demonstrate online or fleet-level operation, while 17 rely on within-cell or k-fold splits that overstate generalization; benchmark reliance is narrow, with 23 papers resting on three public datasets; and the laboratory-to-field gap remains the field’s defining challenge. The review’s sharpest finding is that physics-informed architectures, often assumed to improve reliability by construction, are validated less rigorously than purely data-driven peers (54% versus 73% strong-protocol share): physics priors reduce data demand but do not substitute for rigorous out-of-distribution testing. The paper closes with a conference-path sensitivity analysis, a safety taxonomy for foundation-model components, and BMS-ML-RC, a twelve-item CONSORT-style reporting checklist for future machine-learning BMS studies.

Index Terms—machine learning, battery management systems, lithium-ion batteries, state of charge, state of health, remaining useful life, deep learning, physics-informed neural networks, transfer learning, battery safety

I. INTRODUCTION

A. The battery management problem

Lithium-ion batteries now anchor three converging transitions — electrified road transport, renewable-heavy stationary storage, and the electrification of aerospace and marine systems — and in each the battery is an actively managed asset whose usable capacity, lifetime, and safety depend on real-time operating decisions. The battery management system (BMS) is the embedded cyber-physical layer that makes those decisions — sensing, state estimation, protection, balancing,

and charging negotiation [1]. The difficulty stems from the fact that the quantities that matter most — state of charge (SOC), state of health (SOH), internal temperature, and the onset of degradation or fault mechanisms — are not directly measurable and must be inferred from noisy, partially observable terminal measurements under widely varying conditions. Model-based approaches built on equivalent-circuit or electrochemical models face a persistent fidelity-versus-tractability trade-off, and their parameters drift as cells age [2]. It is in this inference-and-decision layer that machine learning has made its most forceful entry.

Machine learning entered battery management through estimation on hand-engineered features. Two studies then reset expectations. Severson and colleagues predicted the entire cycle life of lithium-ion cells with a median test error near 9% from the first hundred cycles alone, on a public dataset of 124 cells [3]. Attia and colleagues demonstrated closed-loop Bayesian optimization of fast-charging protocols in 2.5 months rather than 18 months of manual experimentation [4]. The five years that followed produced applications across every BMS function: recurrent and convolutional networks for SOC and SOH [5] [6], graph and transformer architectures for prognostics [7] [8], physics-informed neural networks embedding electrochemical and thermal priors [9] [10], transfer learning across chemistries and vehicles [11] [12], reinforcement learning agents [13], and, most recently, large language model (LLM) agents for fleet-scale risk analysis and vehicle-cloud management [14] [15].

B. Existing reviews and the literature gap

The review literature has grown alongside the applications but is fragmented along the same axes as the primary studies: function-specific reviews cover SOC estimation [16] [17], SOH estimation [18], and prognostics [19]; method-specific reviews follow deep-learning state estimation [20], physics-informed impedance diagnostics [21], or interpretable prognosis [22]; and domain reviews examine fault diagnosis [23] [24] and thermal management [25], alongside broader degradation-method surveys [26]. What is missing is a cross-functional account of the field’s trajectory: which method families are used for which tasks, on which data, validated how. Answering this requires a corpus-level account rather than another narrative synthesis of one function.

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The authors are with Leading University, Sylhet, Bangladesh. The classified corpus, the conference sensitivity set, and the complete analysis pipeline are publicly available at github.com/touhidsiddiqueeraj-bit.

C. Contribution of this paper

This paper makes four contributions: a verified corpus of 103 peer-reviewed studies (2019–2026) with every reference confirmed against the Crossref registry by DOI resolution; a two-axis classification framework (BMS function $\times$ method family) extended with chemistry, data-source, and validation-practice fields; a quantified five-year evolution (Section 3); and a function-by-function critical review (Sections 4–8) with a conference-path sensitivity analysis and a gap-driven agenda including a reporting checklist (Section 9). Fig. 1 previews the analysis, mapping the entire corpus across management functions and method families: the field’s center of gravity sits in the health-prognostics complex, hybrid model–data approaches now span every function, and learning-based charging control remains a concentrated Bayesian-optimization stronghold. The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 details the review methodology and its limitations. Section 3 presents the corpus overview and five-year bibliometric analysis. Sections 4 through 7 review machine learning for state estimation, health estimation and prognostics, charging control, and thermal management, fault detection, and safety. Section 8 examines cross-cutting directions, and Sections 9 and 10 give the research agenda and conclusions.

II. REVIEW METHODOLOGY

A. Search strategy

All candidate records were retrieved programmatically from the Crossref REST API between 4 and 5 September 2026 using 30 bibliographic query strings spanning the application areas above. Queries were issued in four passes (top-cited 2020–2026; recency from mid-2024; dedicated 2020–2022 and 2023 windows), yielding 3,000 records; after DOI-based deduplication (1,450 duplicates removed), 1,550 unique records remained. Six landmark studies — including [3] and [2] — were additionally safeguarded as forced seeds: five were retrieved and verified individually because citation-sorted retrieval had crowded them out, and one was already among the top-cited hits. Two properties should be stated plainly. The Crossref registry is a metadata registry, not a discovery engine like Scopus or Web of Science; it was chosen deliberately so that every included record is individually verifiable by direct DOI resolution, at the cost of a recall floor and no cross-database triangulation. Citation-count ordering also favors established, English-language work; the recency passes counter this bias, and all trend statements describe this citation-weighted, English-language, journal-article sample rather than the field in the aggregate.

B. Screening and selection

The screening funnel is shown in Fig. 2. A title-level relevance gate requiring both battery-related and machine-learning terminology retained 883 records and excluded 667 (predominantly adjacent-field papers that surfaced through loose matching). Venue and document-type screening removed 84 records — conference abstracts and proceedings series, preprint servers, and non-scholarly venues — leaving 799

eligible records. A function-quota selection step drew 107 candidate articles balanced across the eight management functions and publication years; six landmark seeds were confirmed or injected (one already captured, five retrieved individually), giving 113 candidates. Full-text curation excluded 19 records (corrigenda, misindexed records, scope mismatches, and quota-driven trimming of over-represented clusters) while 15 targeted additions were made from the screened pool for under-represented themes — a net -4 that yields the final corpus of 103 studies. Inclusion required a peer-reviewed journal article on a battery subject with machine learning as a substantive component (2020–2026, plus one 2019 field-defining seed), verified by direct Crossref DOI resolution; review-only papers were admitted only into the cross-cutting cluster, capped at 12 studies.

C. Classification framework and limitations

Each paper was classified along six fields: management function (eight values, including a cross-cutting cluster); dominant method family (classical ML, deep learning, physics-informed/hybrid, optimization-augmented, reinforcement/control learning, transfer learning, foundation models/LLMs, review); chemistry; primary data source; validation approach; and a coded summary of the headline finding and principal limitation. Three terms are used consistently: a *corpus paper* is any of the 103 included studies; a *primary study* (or *primary-application paper*) is one of the 91 whose contribution is a primary application rather than a review. Classification was performed by the lead author with conservative coding; a co-author verification pass reviewed all 103 classifications, but because it was corrective rather than an independent blind double-coding, we claim no inter-rater agreement statistic — the counts in Section 3 should be read as one documented coding of the corpus, and the complete dataset is released so that independent coders can check or extend it. The synthesis proceeds on two tracks: quantitative cross-tabulations generated programmatically from the released dataset (Section 3), and qualitative function-by-function critique (Sections 4–8). The methodology’s limitations are acknowledged: Crossref coverage excludes influential conference papers; title-level screening can miss relevant work; citation ranking privileges high-profile venues; and no formal reliability statistic is available. These are the reasons this paper describes itself as a scoping review with bibliometric classification rather than a meta-analysis.

III. CORPUS OVERVIEW AND FIVE-YEAR EVOLUTION

A. Publication trend and method-family evolution

The corpus spans 2019–2026 (9, 13, 13, 22, 20, 18, and 7 papers per year from 2020 onward, plus the 2019 seed; Fig. 3), subject to the caveats that it is a curated sample favoring highly cited and recent work and that citation counts over-weight older publications. The defining meta-finding is the compositional shift in method families (Fig. 3, Table I). Classical ML — Gaussian process regression, support vector machines, ensembles, and shallow networks on engineered features — contributes 11 of the 23 papers published from 2019 through

Fig. 1. The corpus mapped across battery-management functions and method families (91 primary-application papers; the 12 corpus reviews are excluded). The “of which reviews” column of Table II states the reconciliation directly; no excluded review belongs to the physics-informed family, so that column’s corpus total of 24 (Table I) is unchanged.

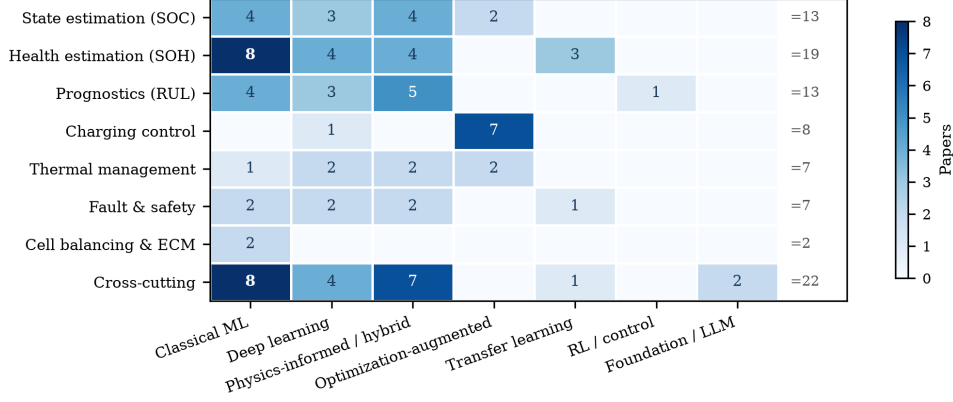
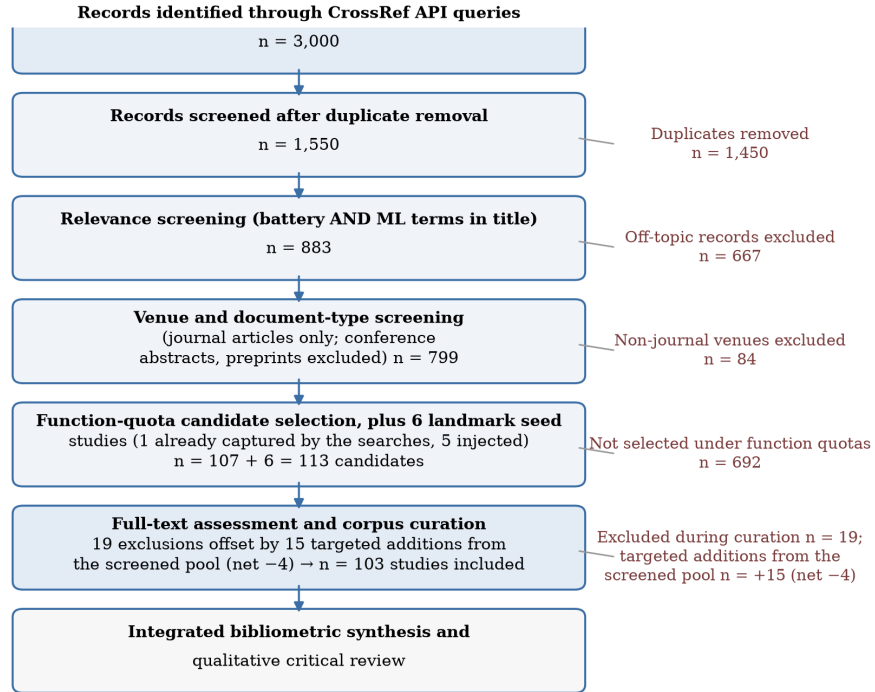


Fig. 2. Study-selection flowchart. Records were retrieved from the Crossref REST API on 4–5 September 2026, deduplicated, screened at title level for battery and machine-learning relevance, screened at venue and document-type level, and curated to the final 103-study corpus.



2021. Deep sequence models rise through 2022–2023 and remain the largest family for prediction tasks. Physics-informed and hybrid model–data learning becomes the modal family by 2024–2026: counted year by year, it contributes 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 4, and 5 papers — 14 of its 24 corpus papers fall in 2024–2026, and it is the largest component of the 7 papers published in 2026 (Table II gives corpus-wide totals). Optimization-augmented learning (Bayesian optimization, surrogate-assisted and meta-heuristic schemes) peaks in 2023–2024 (11 papers); transfer learning accelerates in 2024–2025 (5 papers); reinforcement learning remains scarce but visible (1 corpus paper); and the first foundation-model and LLM-based studies appear in 2025–2026 (2 papers) [14] [15]. Two qualifications

matter: the families are not mutually exclusive (a PSO-tuned LSTM is both deep learning and optimization-augmented), so the composition understates method mixing; and physics-informed papers are, on average, validated no more stringently than others — if anything somewhat less stringently, a point quantified in Section 3.4.

B. Application-area distribution

Functionally, the corpus is dominated by the health-prognostics complex: health estimation (20 papers) and remaining-useful-life prognostics (15) together account for 34% of the 103-paper corpus, followed by the cross-cutting cluster (24), state estimation (17), fault and safety (9), charging

Fig. 3. Evolution of method-family shares in the corpus by publication year. The 2019 seed (classical ML) is omitted for scale.

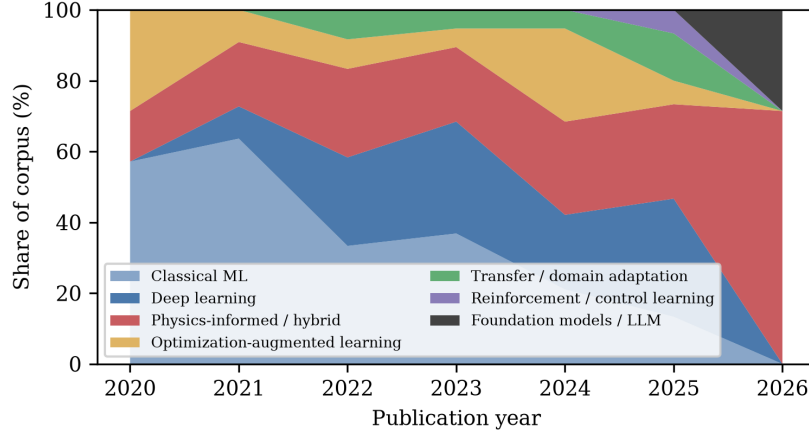


TABLE I
METHOD FAMILIES IN THE CORPUS: REPRESENTATIVE TECHNIQUES, STRENGTHS, AND LIMITATIONS

Method family	Papers	Representative techniques	Strengths	Limitations
Classical ML	29	Gaussian process regression, SVM/SVR, ensembles, shallow networks on engineered features	Calibrated uncertainty; small-data friendly; cheap to embed	Feature engineering is manual; ceilings under complex dynamics
Deep learning	19	LSTM/GRU, CNN, attention/Transformer, autoencoders, graph networks	Learns features from raw curves; strong trajectory modeling	Data-hungry; weak extrapolation; opaque
Physics-informed / hybrid	24	PINNs, physics-constrained autoencoders, filter-embedded networks, multiphysics fusion	Structure aids extrapolation; reduced data demand	Inherits simplified-model bias; harder to train
Optimization-augmented	11	Bayesian optimization, surrogate-assisted multi-objective design, meta-heuristic-tuned networks	Sample-efficient protocol discovery; explicit trade-off handling	Offline tuning cost; surrogate bias
Transfer / domain adaptation	5	Domain-adversarial training, fine-tuning across chemistry/protocol	Directly targets the generalization gap	Negative transfer; needs shared protocols
Reinforcement / control learning	1	Deep-RL prognostic model selection	Adaptive decision-making along trajectories	Training stability; scarce hardware validation
Foundation models / LLM	2	Domain-tuned LLM agents for risk analysis and orchestration	Reasoning over heterogeneous text/system context	Hallucination risk; latency and cost
Review / perspective	12	Narrative and systematic syntheses	Maps the field; identifies shared gaps	No primary validation

control (8), thermal management (8), and cell balancing (2) (Fig. 1; Table III gives the composition by year, with the review reconciliation; Table IV maps representative studies across all functions). This concentration mirrors publication-volume patterns in the wider literature and the commercial pull of lifetime prediction for warranties and second-life markets. The thin representation of cell balancing is telling: balancing remains dominated by classical control practice, and the corpus’s most-cited balancing-related result is the demonstration that routine balancing can be dispensed with in well-managed packs, reducing hazardous lithium-plating side reactions [27]. Venue concentration is equally marked — the Journal of Energy Storage (14 papers), Energy (13), and Applied Energy (9) head the corpus — a sign that impact is currently demonstrated in application terms rather than in methodological novelty.

C. Data landscape and validation practice

The data underpinning the corpus are strikingly concentrated: 36 papers rest on laboratory cycling of the authors’ own cells; the public Severson/Toyota–MIT–Stanford (MATR)

dataset alone supports 11, NASA and CALCE 6 each, and laboratory impedance spectroscopy 6; 10 papers use real vehicle or fleet data as their primary source — distinct from the 9 studies whose validation is an online or real-vehicle demonstration (Table V); 12 are simulation-based; and 15 are reviews or perspectives. Chemistry reporting is similarly skewed: 53 papers work on NMC-based cells and 15 on LFP, leaving sodium-ion, solid-state, and high-temperature systems nearly absent from the ML-management literature. Validation practice is arguably the field’s most consequential weakness. Cross-cell holdout — the strongest common laboratory protocol — accounts for 24 papers, and cross-chemistry or cross-domain transfer studies for 10; but within-cell splits (12 papers) and unsupervised k-fold cross-validation (5) leak trajectory information between train and test, producing optimistic errors that do not survive cell-to-cell variability. Only 9 studies validate a system online or on fleet data, and only 7 validate across chemistries. Crossing validation practice with method family substantiates the remark in Section 3.1 with numbers: 13 of the 24 physics-informed/hybrid papers (54%) use one of the strong protocols, against 49 of the other 67 primary-

TABLE II

CORPUS COMPOSITION: MANAGEMENT FUNCTION BY PUBLICATION YEAR. THE REVIEWS COLUMN COUNTS THE 12 METHOD-FAMILY REVIEWS; PRIMARY = TOTAL — REVIEWS GIVES THE PRIMARY-APPLICATION COUNTS USED IN FIG. 1.

Function	'19	'20	'21	'22	'23	'24	'25	'26	Total	Reviews	Primary
Cell balancing & ECM	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	0	2	0	2
Charging control	0	2	0	0	2	3	1	0	8	0	8
Cross-cutting	0	1	0	6	8	3	2	4	24	2	22
Fault & safety	0	0	2	0	2	3	2	0	9	2	7
Health estimation (SOH)	0	2	3	2	4	3	4	2	20	1	19
Prognostics (RUL)	1	1	3	2	1	1	6	0	15	2	13
State estimation (SOC)	0	3	4	2	1	5	2	0	17	4	13
Thermal management	0	0	1	1	3	1	1	1	8	1	7
Total	1	9	13	13	22	20	18	7	103	12	91

application papers (73%) — a physics prior does not, in itself, buy validation rigor.

The benchmark concentration can be stated as a metric (Fig. 4). Across 2019–2026, 23 corpus papers — more than a fifth of the primary-application corpus — rest on the same three public benchmarks. Because these benchmarks together contain on the order of a few hundred cells, the field’s effective empirical sample has grown far more slowly than its publication count: output rose from single digits per year in 2019–2020 to 15–20 papers per year by 2023–2025, while benchmark reuse kept pace step for step. We call this pattern benchmark saturation: the empirical base on which the community calibrates and compares estimators is approximately fixed while the literature multiplies on top of it, inflating apparent comparability and hiding dataset-specific failure modes.

D. Sensitivity analysis: does the journal-only corpus understate validation practice?

Because the corpus excludes conference proceedings — a major venue for control-oriented BMS work (CDC, ACC, IFAC, VPPC, ITEC) — the validation findings could in principle be a venue-selection artifact. To test this, we curated a sensitivity set of 14 machine-learning battery papers from six control and transportation-electrification venues (2019–2025), retrieved by venue-scoped Crossref queries, restricted to proceedings articles, ranked by citation count, and verified by the same DOI-resolution procedure as the main corpus (released as `conference_sensitivity.csv`). Validation practice was classified conservatively from the indexed abstracts (Table III). The result supports representativeness rather than a venue gap: only 2 of the 14 conference papers (14%) state hardware or experimental validation in their indexed abstracts, 2 rest on public datasets, and 4 describe simulation-level validation — against 19 of the 91 primary-application journal papers (21%) with experimental-hardware demonstrations and a 68% strong-protocol share. Abstract-level transparency about validation is, if anything, lower on the conference path. Two caveats bound this finding: conference abstracts are frequently truncated in bibliographic indexes, so the comparison measures stated evidence rather than underlying practice; and the set is a curated sample, not a census. Within those bounds, the journal-only corpus does not understate the field’s validation transparency — and neither venue type reports validation systematically, which strengthens the case for the reporting standards proposed in Section 9.

IV. MACHINE LEARNING FOR BATTERY STATE ESTIMATION

SOC estimation is the most mature BMS function, and the corpus shows how machine learning entered it. The early pattern pairs learning with classical estimation: Gaussian process regression for pack-level SOC with native uncertainty quantification [42], and — most influentially — recurrent networks embedded in unscented Kalman filters, where the LSTM supplies a learned observation model and the filter recursive correction [5]. A second generation tuned network structure itself: particle-swarm-optimized LSTM improved accuracy and noise robustness [43], and evolutionary-assisted CNN-BiLSTM hybrids report sub-1% drive-cycle errors [44]. Simulation-informed training pipelines substitute automotive-accurate simulated data for exhaustive cell testing [45], comparative benchmarks on standard drive cycles weigh ML regression families [46], pack heterogeneity is addressed by joint pack-SOC and cell-inconsistency estimation with balancing-aware formulations [47], and unified frameworks estimate SOH and SOC jointly from partial charging data [48], and large-format applications extend estimation to containerized storage strings [49], with comparative benchmarks weighing accuracy against embedded compute budgets [50] [51].

The most substantive recent shift is toward hybrid schemes in which a filter, an equivalent-circuit model, or a physics prior constrains the learner: GA-optimized LSTM coupled with improved adaptive Kalman filtering reaches low error under measurement noise that breaks pure-network estimators [52]; equivalent-circuit-informed ML on impedance features estimates SOC across temperatures [53]; and physics-informed recurrent structures embed battery dynamics directly into the training objective [10]. These schemes trade engineering complexity for extrapolation behavior — the property that matters most onboard. Yet 13 of the 17 corpus SOC papers rest on laboratory-scale data and 12 on a single chemistry, and only one demonstrates fleet-scale operation [49]; benchmark heterogeneity makes cross-paper comparison nearly meaningless [20] [17]. The laboratory problem is largely solved; the deployment problem — guaranteed accuracy on arbitrary packs over full aging — is not.

V. MACHINE LEARNING FOR HEALTH ESTIMATION AND PROGNOSTICS

SOH estimation and RUL prediction form the largest functional block of the corpus (35 papers). The founding pattern is

Fig. 4. Benchmark saturation. Papers using the three dominant public benchmarks per year (stacked bars, left axis) against total corpus output per year (line, right axis).

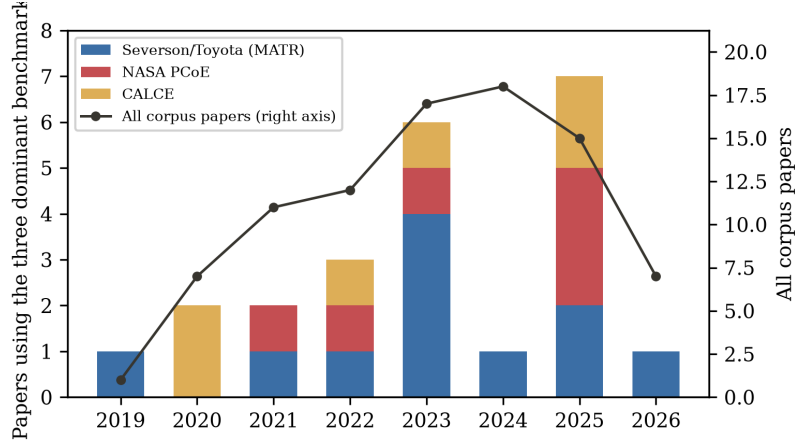


TABLE III

CONFERENCE SENSITIVITY SET: 14 MACHINE-LEARNING BATTERY PAPERS FROM CONTROL AND TRANSPORTATION-ELECTRIFICATION VENUES (2019–2025), CROSSREF-VERIFIED, WITH VALIDATION EVIDENCE STATED IN THEIR INDEXED ABSTRACTS.

Venue (year)	Function	Method family (short)	Validation evidence stated in indexed abstract
ITEC 2019	SOC	LSTM recurrent network [28]	Not stated
VPPC 2021	SOH	ML ensemble [29]	Public dataset
ITEC 2022	SOC+SOH	Dual extended Kalman filter [30]	Not stated
ACC 2023	SOC+SOH	Real-time estimator + batch least squares [31]	Not stated
ACC 2021	SOC	Multiple-model adaptive estimation [32]	Simulation-level
ITEC 2023	SOH	Histogram data + PCA + regression [33]	Public dataset
APEC 2023	Overview	Review of ML-enabled estimation [34]	Not applicable
ECC 2021	SOH	Reinforcement learning + observer [35]	Not stated
CCDC 2022	SOH	CNN-BiLSTM transfer learning [36]	Hardware (stated); public data
VPPC 2019	SOC	SVR + PCA with dual-polarization model [37]	Not stated
ACC 2024	SOC+SOH	EKF critique and improvement [38]	Simulation-level
VPPC 2022	Prognostics	ML on aging data [39]	Hardware (stated)
VPPC 2019	SOC	Kalman filter on reduced electrochemical model [40]	Simulation-level
VPPC 2021	SOC	Computationally efficient neural network [41]	Simulation-level

classical: extract health-sensitive features from partial charge or discharge curves, then regress with Gaussian process or similar shallow models — incremental-capacity analysis with explicit uncertainty bounds [54], differential thermal voltammetry [55], and Gaussian-process classification of impedance spectra that identifies degradation modes [56], and deep Gaussian processes coupling prognosis with degradation-mode identification [57]. Measurement relaxations followed: random partial charging data proved sufficient for accurate SOH [58], and charging-segment adjustment refined features for vehicle-level use [59]. The landmark systematization is Roman et al.’s 179-cell pipeline showing that relaxed charge-curve features support accurate SOH estimation across a heterogeneous commercial fleet [60].

Deep architectures entered as sequence models over capacity-fade trajectories and representation learners over raw curves: graph convolutional networks fusing multiple health indicators [7], graph networks over partial discharge curves [61], BiLSTM–Transformer hybrids under fast-charging stress [8], hybrid-fusion networks for real-time prediction streams [62], and interpretable deep learning with transparency mechanisms [63]. Field-data studies absorb real-vehicle noise [6] and estimate pack-level SOH from fleet streams [64], while

deep models estimate SOH without additional degradation experiments by learning trajectory features that generalize across chemistries [65]. Early-life prediction — forecasting lifetime from the first cycles — compresses test times from months to days [3] [66] [67], hybrid physics-plus-learned models give early RUL from limited cycles [68], extends to lithium-metal chemistries [69], and now runs on embedded boards in real time [70].

The prognostics cluster shows the clearest physics-informed turn: physics-informed online degradation models [71], hybrid reinforcement learning that reduces the data demand of SOH estimation [72], a generalizable PINN from limited early-cycle data [73], EIS-informed physics-constrained networks [74], a generic physics-informed RUL framework for small early-life samples [75], multi-feature hybrids across datasets [76], recurrent networks anticipating uncertain duty [77], and signal-decomposition hybrids on noisy capacity series [78]. Transfer learning attacks generalization directly: domain-adversarial training across operating conditions [11], deep transfer with partial charging curves across cell types [12], transfer under fast-charging protocols [79], cross-chemistry EIS estimation [80], and a general framework quantifying the laboratory-to-fleet domain gap [81]. The critical assessment: accuracy claims

cluster around 1–2% SOH error, but they are established overwhelmingly on public benchmark cells — 10 of the 35 studies in this complex use within-cell or k-fold validation (17 corpus-wide) — and the transfer-learning papers, the honest exception, reveal how much shift remains unaddressed. SOH estimation under controlled conditions is approaching incremental returns; calibrated lifetime and safety margins for arbitrary packs in the field remain open [2] [19].

VI. MACHINE LEARNING FOR CHARGING CONTROL AND OPTIMIZATION

Charging control is the function where machine learning has changed experimental practice most directly. The defining result is Attia et al.: a Bayesian optimization loop identified fast-charging protocols within 2.5 months, against roughly 18 months of manual search [4]. Ensemble surrogates make multi-objective strategy optimization tractable [83], and Bayesian fast-charging optimization reduces charge time under degradation constraints [90]. A second line embeds degradation mechanisms into the decision itself: machine-learning fast charging that perceives and regulates internal lithium-plating onset enables plating-free rapid protocols [82], adaptive multi-stage schemes adjust stage boundaries against measured degradation [91], module-level optimization manages temperature gradients [92], and pack-level extensions coordinate balance-aware charging [93] [94].

The deployment gap is most concrete here: of the eight charging papers, one is a large-scale closed-loop hardware campaign, three validate on laboratory hardware, and the rest are simulation-only. The unsolved problem is certifiable learning-based charging — which is why mechanism-aware schemes such as plating-perception control [82] are the cluster’s most deployment-relevant results.

VII. MACHINE LEARNING FOR THERMAL MANAGEMENT, FAULTS AND SAFETY

Thermal management (8 papers) divides by purpose. For estimation, ANN models predict cell temperature across operating conditions [84] and internal-temperature sensing extends to ultrahigh-rate discharge where surface measurement fails [95]. For design, ML surrogates amortize expensive CFD evaluation across optimization loops [96] [85], with experimentally validated parallel-liquid-cooling designs closing the loop [97]. For control, ANN controllers demonstrate parasitic-load reductions in simulation [98] — but no corpus paper closes this loop on hardware, leaving thermal control where charging control was five years ago. Physics-informed heat-generation estimation embeds thermal priors into the learning problem [9], and the cluster is consolidated by a state-of-the-art review [25].

Fault and safety applications (9 papers) divide into diagnosis of realized faults and prediction of impending hazards: grid-search-optimized SVMs classify sensor and connection faults [86], curvilinear-distance methods detect multiple pack fault types in operating fleets [99], and multi-scenario deep anomaly detection covers real EV operating envelopes [100];

force-signal deep learning catches lithium-plating-type defects at manufacturing [101]. The hazard-prediction side is increasingly model-based: multiphysics models coupled with ML predict module-level thermal-runaway progression [87], a multiphysics-informed DeepONet augments scarce experimental events with virtual data [102], and multi-source domain transfer moves thermal-runaway diagnosis across fleets with small target samples [88]. The reviews in this cluster are candid that laboratory fault diagnosis has historically failed to transfer to real vehicles [24] [23]; the fleet-data anomaly-detection studies are therefore the cluster’s most valuable trend, even though label scarcity for rare faults keeps evaluation largely qualitative.

VIII. CROSS-CUTTING DIRECTIONS

A. *Physics-informed learning, interpretability, and uncertainty*

Physics-informed and hybrid model-data learning is the corpus’s largest methodological theme (24 papers across all functions) — in state estimation [10] [103], heat-generation estimation [9], prognostics [71], and impedance-based diagnostics [21], with physics-constrained autoencoders improving health prediction over purely learned counterparts [104] and a physical-plus-data-driven fusion literature for internal-state estimation [105]. The caution is that most physics-informed studies embed simplified physics — equivalent-circuit or reduced electrochemical models — so the hybrid inherits model bias even as it gains structure, and its validation is no stronger than that of purely data-driven peers (Section 3.4). A smaller but consequential cluster makes learning systems inspectable: explainability-driven feature selection improves estimator robustness [106], interpretable ML links manufacturing coating parameters to cell capacity [107], interpretable hybrid ML untangles degradation chemistries in lithium-sulfur cells [108], and uncertainty-aware models deliver calibrated early-life predictions [89]. For safety cases only calibrated uncertainty has a route into certification; attribution supports debugging.

B. *Digital twins, cloud BMS, and new sensing*

System-level architecture is emerging as a research object: digital twins track individual battery aging through incremental learning [109] and couple LSTM surrogates with real-time thermal observation [110]; cloud platforms perform in-situ life prediction at fleet scale [111]; second-life workflows use impedance-based accelerated SOH estimation to triage retired packs [112], and learned battery models with numerical search estimate real-time state-of-power [113]. Non-electrical sensing broadens the measurement base — ultrasonic signatures provide a SOC channel orthogonal to voltage sensing [114] — and ML mappings from equivalent-circuit parameters to electrochemical properties give classical BMS models a physically interpretable learned layer [115]. These settings differ in latency budgets, error tolerance, and update cadence, and the field is beginning to design for those differences. Production-side mapping [116], coating interpretability [107], and defect detection [101] complete the picture: cell quality is itself a BMS input.

TABLE IV

REPRESENTATIVE CORPUS STUDIES BY MANAGEMENT FUNCTION AND METHOD FAMILY. ENTRIES GLOSS EACH STUDY AS: STUDY SUMMARY (DATA BASIS; HEADLINE CONTRIBUTION). REFERENCES IN BRACKETS REFER TO THE NUMBERED LIST.

Function	Method family	Representative studies (data; contribution)
State estimation (SOC)	Filter-embedded learning; meta-heuristic DL	LSTM+UKF embedded estimator (laboratory cells; learned observation model in a UKF) [5]; PSO-LSTM (laboratory cells; meta-heuristically tuned recurrent SOC) [43]; GA-LSTM with adaptive Kalman filtering (laboratory cells; low error under noise) [52]
Health estimation (SOH)	Classical ML; deep learning; transfer learning	ML pipeline over 179 cells (own cell fleet; relaxed charge-curve features) [60]; deep learning without extra degradation experiments (public MATR dataset; cross-chemistry generalization) [65]; real-world vehicle SOH (fleet data; field-noise robustness) [6]
Prognostics (RUL)	Classical ML; physics-informed; RL	Early-life cycle prediction (public MATR dataset; about 9% median test error) [3]; physics-informed early-cycle RUL (multiple datasets; small-data prognosis) [75]; deep-RL prognostic model fusion (public NASA dataset; adaptive model selection) [13]
Charging control	Bayesian optimization; mechanism-aware control	Closed-loop Bayesian protocol optimization (hardware prototype; 2.5 versus 18 months to a protocol) [4]; plating-perceiving fast charging (hardware prototype; plating-free protocols) [82]; ensemble-surrogate charging optimization (laboratory cells; multi-objective strategies) [83]
Thermal management	ANN surrogate; physics-informed; optimization	ANN temperature prediction (laboratory cells; low-error thermal model) [84]; PINN heat-generation estimation (simulation; embedded thermal physics) [9]; ML-assisted BTMS design (simulation; multi-objective cooling design) [85]
Fault & safety	Shallow ML; multiphysics + ML; transfer learning	SVM fault diagnosis (hardware prototype; sensor and connection faults) [86]; multiphysics-ML runaway prediction (simulation and hardware; module-level hazard) [87]; cross-fleet runaway-diagnosis transfer (fleet data; small-sample diagnosis) [88]
Cross-cutting	Physics-informed; XAI; digital twin; LLM	EIS diagnostics PINN review (multiple studies; paradigm synthesis) [21]; uncertainty-aware early-life prediction (public MATR dataset; calibrated forecasts) [89]; LLM vehicle-cloud management (fleet data; orchestration layer) [15]

C. Foundation models and LLM-based management

The corpus’s youngest theme is generative: domain-specific LLMs perform risk analysis of battery energy-storage incidents [14], and knowledge-enhanced LLM agents orchestrate vehicle-cloud battery management [15]. Because BMS software is safety-critical, this review positions foundation models not as better estimators but as orchestration layers, and Table VII makes the division of labor explicit: the right-hand guardrails are normative guidance proposed here, not claims about the published studies. Two entries deserve emphasis. Failure mode: an estimator’s error is a bounded number, while an LLM’s failure is open-ended hallucinated text — so LLM outputs must be restricted to structured, checkable forms and never feed protection logic as free text. Safety authority: LLM components must never hold direct cell-level protection authority; that role belongs to physics-based envelopes and calibrated estimators whose uncertainty is quantified.

IX. RESEARCH GAPS, REPORTING STANDARDS, AND FUTURE DIRECTIONS

Cross-referencing the bibliometric analysis of Section 3 with the function-level reviews yields six structural gaps. (1) Validation practice: 17 primary studies use within-cell or unsupervised k-fold validation, and only 9 of all 103 demonstrate online or fleet use; standardized cross-cell, cross-chemistry, and lab-to-fleet transfer protocols should become reporting norms, as already practiced by the transfer-learning and general-framework studies [81] [80]. (2) Data monoculture: a single public dataset underlies 11 studies, NASA and CALCE sustain much of the rest, and 36 papers use private laboratory cells; federated learning over fleets, anonymized

fleet-data releases, and multi-institution cycling campaigns — in the spirit of the 179-cell pipeline [60] — would diversify the evidence base, and papers should at minimum disclose split definitions, seeds, and compute budgets. (3) Edge deployment: only isolated works treat onboard compute, memory, and latency as first-class constraints [70] [117]; quantization-aware training, resource-constrained architecture search, and cloud-edge hybrid designs are the natural research program. (4) Trust: uncertainty must be calibrated rather than post-hoc [89], interpretability must bound behavior rather than merely attribute it, and hybrid physics-data architectures are the most credible certification path because part of their behavior is analytically specified. (5) Foundation-model integration: the first LLM studies [14] [15] suggest a division of labor — foundation models for reasoning and orchestration, conventional ML for calibrated estimation, physics models for safety envelopes — that should be formalized with grounding and latency guarantees. (6) Under-served functions: balancing is nearly untouched beyond pack-level insight [27], charging needs certifiable adaptive protocols, and thermal management remains simulation-dominated [25]; these are control problems where errors act on the battery, so closing them requires the safety-case machinery of gap 4 as much as new algorithms.

A. A reporting checklist for machine-learning BMS studies

The most concrete artifact this review can offer is procedural. Modeled on the CONSORT and PRISMA checklists, Table IX proposes a twelve-item BMS-ML reporting checklist (BMS-ML-RC): the minimum metadata a study should disclose for its accuracy claims to be comparable, reproducible, and poolable. Each item corresponds to a practice

TABLE V

SAFETY AND VERIFICATION TAXONOMY FOR FOUNDATION-MODEL COMPONENTS IN THE BMS STACK. THE RIGHT-HAND COLUMN IS NORMATIVE GUIDANCE PROPOSED BY THIS REVIEW, NOT CLAIMS ABOUT THE PUBLISHED STUDIES.

Dimension	Classical / deep ML estimators (established practice)	Published LLM studies (2025–2026)	Required guardrail (this review)
Role in the stack	Calibrated numeric estimation and detection	Incident risk analysis [14]; vehicle-cloud orchestration [15]	Estimation stays with calibrated ML; LLM coordinates, summarizes, explains
Grounding	Trained on domain cycling data	Domain-tuned corpora and knowledge-enhanced prompting	Retrieval over verified corpora with source citations; no ungrounded recall
Dominant failure mode	Bounded numeric error under distribution shift	Open-ended hallucinated text	Outputs restricted to structured, checkable forms; never free text into protection logic
Uncertainty	Gaussian-process / conformal intervals in a subset of studies	Not quantified in published studies	Calibrated intervals mandatory before any actuation-adjacent role
Latency and compute	Millisecond-class, onboard	Second-class, cloud-dependent	Offline analysis and planning only unless real-time evidence is shown
Safety authority	Bounded by physics envelopes and thresholds	Undefined in published studies	LLM components must never hold direct cell-level protection authority

whose absence the corpus analysis showed to be distorting — undisclosed splits, uncalibrated uncertainty, unnamed datasets, unquantified compute. We suggest journals adopt it as a submission checklist and that authors attach it to their released datasets.

X. CONCLUSION

This review has examined AI-powered battery management through a verified 103-study corpus extended by a 14-paper conference sensitivity analysis. Three conclusions stand out. First, the field has undergone a marked methodological evolution: classical feature-based learners gave way to deep sequence models, now being displaced at the frontier by physics-informed hybrids, optimization-augmented learning, transfer-learning regimes, and foundation-model components. Second, the center of gravity remains estimation (state, health, lifetime), where learning systems have largely succeeded on laboratory terms; control functions (charging, thermal, balancing) remain demonstrably transformable but under-evidenced for deployment. Third, published accuracy progress is not matched by validation progress: online or fleet-level demonstration appears in fewer than one study in ten, benchmark monoculture distorts the apparent state of the art, and the field's favored remedy — physics-informed architecture — does not substitute for validation rigor (54% versus 73% strong-protocol validation). The near-term agenda follows directly: standardized cross-domain validation protocols, diversified fleet data, edge-deployable architectures, calibrated uncertainty as a certification prerequisite, and a principled division of labor between foundation models, calibrated estimators, and physics-based safety envelopes. If the last five years were about discovering what machine learning can estimate about a battery, the next five will be decided by what it can be trusted to do — onboard, at fleet scale, across chemistries, and over full cell lifetimes.

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TABLE VI
PROPOSED BMS-ML REPORTING CHECKLIST (BMS-ML-RC), MODELED ON CONSORT/PRISMA REPORTING STANDARDS.

#	Reporting item	What must be reported
1	Dataset identity	Exact name and version of every dataset (e.g., Severson-MATR, NASA, CALCE); download source
2	Cell population	Number of cells, chemistry, manufacturer, format, and batch for every training and test set
3	Sensor and sampling context	Measured channels, sampling rate, sensor class, and temperature conditions
4	Split protocol	Split type (within-cell / cross-cell / cross-chemistry / cross-domain) and isolation argument; within-cell splits must be flagged as such
5	Out-of-distribution evaluation	At least one protocol under which test conditions differ from training (chemistry, temperature, protocol, or source)
6	Baselines	At least one classical baseline alongside the proposed architecture, with identical data
7	Randomness control	Seeds or repeated-run statistics for every stochastic training result
8	Uncertainty	Calibrated uncertainty or error bars for headline claims, not point estimates alone
9	Compute budget	Training compute and inference latency/memory on the target (or a stated reference) platform
10	Failure analysis	At least one documented failure mode and its distribution (where the model is worst)
11	Validation environment	Which of the following applies: simulation, laboratory cycling, hardware prototype, online/fleet
12	Artifact availability	Data and code deposit (DOI-backed) or an explicit stated exemption

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